Several years after the Falklands war, we had to face another crisis involving an ally.

In September 1984, Cardinal Jaime Sin, the Catholic prelate in Manila, came to Washington and told me that many Filipino people believed Marcos was responsible for the murder of his political rival, Benigno Aquino. He said there was growing anti-Marcos sentiment among the people that, if unchecked, would fuel the cause of Communist rebels in the Philippines. The cardinal said that he believed Marcos had to go, and I think he was seeking American support for those in Manila who were trying to oust him. I was surprised at the intensity of his remarks but made no commitment.

The future of the Philippines was of great importance to the United States. Our huge military stations there, Clark Air Force Base and the Subic Bay naval base, were among our largest in the world and the anchor of our defense in the western Pacific; and we had had no stronger ally anywhere than Marcos. The February following Cardinal Sin's visit, senior U.S. diplomats in Manila reported that Marcos had developed a serious kidney ailment and was putting in less than two hours a day of work; his wife, Imelda, they said, was keeping people from her husband while making important presidential decisions herself. But they agreed that Marcos still represented our best counterforce to the Communist rebels and that we should maintain our support for him.

Later that year, I began to receive reports from our ambassador in Manila, Stephen Bosworth, that the Communist insurgents in the Philippines were continuing to make political gains and that Marcos was underestimating the effect of his policies on the Filipino people. I asked Senator Paul Laxalt to go to Manila to investigate the reports. He confirmed that substantial public outrage was building against Marcos—the force that later came to be